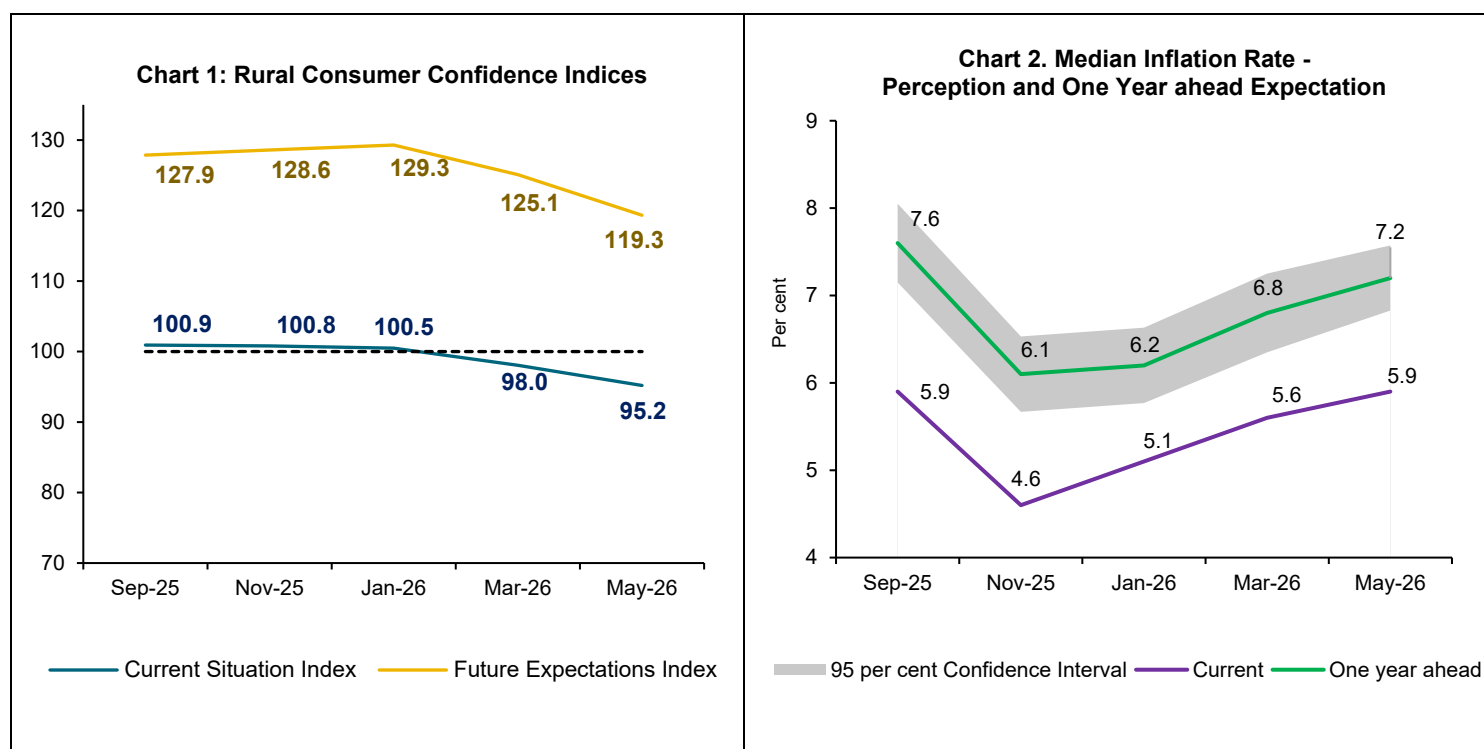


Rural Consumer Confidence Survey

Today, the Reserve Bank released the results of May 2026 round of its bi-monthly Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS)¹². The survey collects current perceptions (*vis-à-vis* a year ago) and one year ahead expectations of households, on general economic situation, employment scenario, overall price situation, own income and spending, besides information on inflation. The survey was conducted during May 2-11, 2026, covering 8,813 responses in the rural and semi-urban areas across all Indian states and three major UTs.

Highlights:

- Rural consumer confidence for the current period weakened further; the Current Situation Index (CSI)³ declined sequentially in previous two rounds (Chart 1; Table 9).
- Though in the optimistic zone, the Future Expectations Index (FEI) declined to 119.3 due to worsening conditions across all parameters except price (Chart 1; Table 9).
- Inflation perception and year-ahead expectation for rural households increased by 30 bps and 40 bps, reaching to 5.9 per cent and 7.2 per cent, respectively (Chart 2; Table 12).



Note: [Please see the excel file for time series data⁴](#)

¹ The rural consumer confidence survey covers both rural and semi-urban areas.

² The survey results reflect the respondents' views, which are not necessarily shared by the Reserve Bank. Results of the previous survey round were released on the Bank's website on [April 08, 2026](#).

³ CSI and FEI are compiled with the net responses on five survey parameters viz., general economic situation, employment, income, price level and spending, for the current period (as compared with one year ago) and a year ahead, respectively. CSI and FEI = 100 + Average of Net Responses of the above parameters.

⁴ Unit-level data for previous rounds of the survey are available on the Bank's 'Database on Indian Economy' (DBIE) portal (weblink: <https://data.rbi.org.in/DBIE/#/dbie/home>) under the head 'Unit-level Data'.

Summary based on Net Responses ⁵						
Main Variables	Current Perceptions			One year ahead Expectations		
	Mar-26	May-26	Change	Mar-26	May-26	Change
Economic Situation	1.6	-2.5	↓	35.8	28.5	↓
Employment	2.6	-1.2	↓	33.9	29.8	↓
Price Level	-89.6	-90.0	↓	-78.2	-76.6	↑
Income	-6.7	-5.8	↑	45.7	38.9	↓
Spending	82.3	75.4	↓	88.3	76.0	↓
Consumer Confidence Index	98.0	95.2	↓	125.1	119.3	↓
↑ Positive Sentiments with sign of improvement compared to last round			↑ Negative Sentiments with sign of improvement compared to last round			
↓ Positive Sentiments with sign of deterioration compared to last round			↓ Negative Sentiments with sign of deterioration compared to last round			
↔ Positive Sentiments with no change compared to last round			↔ Negative Sentiments with no change compared to last round			

⁵ 'Net response' is the difference between the percentage of respondents reporting optimism and those reporting pessimisms. It ranges between -100 and 100. Any value greater than zero indicates expansion/ optimism and values less than zero indicate contraction/ pessimism.

Table 1: Perceptions and Expectations on the General Economic Situation								
(Percentage responses)								
Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Improved	Remained Same	Worsened	Net Response	Will Improve	Will Remain Same	Will Worsen	Net Response
May-25	40.8	25.3	33.9	6.9	60.3	16.7	23.1	37.2
Jul-25	41.6	24.0	34.4	7.1	59.6	21.2	19.2	40.4
Sep-25	39.4	28.4	32.2	7.2	58.4	23.5	18.1	40.3
Nov-25	40.0	27.4	32.7	7.3	58.7	23.0	18.3	40.4
Jan-26	40.3	26.9	32.8	7.5	59.5	23.0	17.5	42.0
Mar-26	36.3	29.1	34.7	1.6	56.2	23.4	20.4	35.8
May-26	34.6	28.4	37.1	-2.5	53.1	22.4	24.5	28.5

Table 2: Perceptions and Expectations on Employment								
(Percentage responses)								
Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Improved	Remained Same	Worsened	Net Response	Will Improve	Will Remain Same	Will Worsen	Net Response
May-25	39.9	25.0	35.2	4.7	59.9	18.7	21.4	38.5
Jul-25	38.0	28.8	33.3	4.7	57.6	24.7	17.7	39.9
Sep-25	36.0	33.1	30.9	5.0	57.0	26.2	16.7	40.3
Nov-25	36.5	31.6	31.8	4.7	57.3	25.9	16.7	40.6
Jan-26	36.2	32.7	31.1	5.2	57.4	26.8	15.8	41.6
Mar-26	35.3	32.0	32.7	2.6	54.3	25.4	20.4	33.9
May-26	33.6	31.6	34.8	-1.2	52.6	24.6	22.8	29.8

Table 3: Perceptions and Expectations on Price Level								
(Percentage responses)								
Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Increased	Remained Same	Decreased	Net Response	Will Increase	Will Remain Same	Will Decrease	Net Response
May-25	94.6	3.9	1.5	-93.1	88.5	4.9	6.6	-81.9
Jul-25	94.2	3.6	2.2	-92.0	88.5	3.9	7.7	-80.8
Sep-25	94.4	3.5	2.2	-92.2	83.9	11.5	4.6	-79.3
Nov-25	92.8	1.8	5.4	-87.4	82.6	11.6	5.9	-76.7
Jan-26	90.8	7.4	1.8	-89.0	82.1	12.9	5.0	-77.1
Mar-26	91.1	7.4	1.5	-89.6	83.2	11.9	4.9	-78.2
May-26	90.8	8.3	0.8	-90.0	82.8	11.0	6.2	-76.6

Table 4: Perceptions and Expectations on Rate of Change in Price Level (Inflation)*

(Percentage responses)

Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Increased	Remained Same	Decreased	Net Response	Will Increase	Will Remain Same	Will Decrease	Net Response
May-25	77.6	17.8	4.6	-73.0	77.9	16.9	5.1	-72.8
Jul-25	77.4	16.9	5.8	-71.6	77.9	16.7	5.5	-72.3
Sep-25	76.9	17.9	5.2	-71.8	79.5	12.0	8.5	-71.0
Nov-25	76.9	11.5	11.6	-65.3	77.0	12.3	10.7	-66.3
Jan-26	76.2	14.5	9.3	-67.0	75.2	17.8	7.1	-68.1
Mar-26	78.2	11.6	10.3	-67.9	76.1	16.5	7.3	-68.8
May-26	75.5	18.2	6.3	-69.2	72.7	18.9	8.4	-64.3

Notes: *Applicable only for those respondents who felt price has increased/price will increase.**Table 5: Perceptions and Expectations on Income**

(Percentage responses)

Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Increased	Remained Same	Decreased	Net Response	Will Increase	Will Remain Same	Will Decrease	Net Response
May-25	25.3	44.7	30.0	-4.8	59.7	29.9	10.4	49.3
Jul-25	23.7	49.4	26.8	-3.1	58.0	35.3	6.8	51.2
Sep-25	24.5	49.0	26.5	-2.1	56.3	38.8	4.9	51.4
Nov-25	24.1	49.7	26.3	-2.2	59.1	33.6	7.4	51.7
Jan-26	22.6	51.6	25.9	-3.3	57.1	37.8	5.1	52.0
Mar-26	21.6	50.2	28.2	-6.7	55.9	34.0	10.2	45.7
May-26	21.6	51.0	27.4	-5.8	51.4	36.2	12.5	38.9

Table 6: Perceptions and Expectations on Spending

(Percentage responses)

Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Increased	Remained Same	Decreased	Net Response	Will Increase	Will Remain Same	Will Decrease	Net Response
May-25	88.1	10.0	2.0	86.1	89.7	8.3	2.0	87.8
May-25	87.0	12.3	0.7	86.3	90.9	6.3	2.9	88.0
Sep-25	88.2	10.3	1.5	86.7	87.8	11.1	1.1	86.7
Nov-25	84.5	12.5	3.0	81.5	88.8	9.3	1.9	86.9
Jan-26	82.9	16.2	0.9	82.0	89.9	8.2	1.9	88.0
Mar-26	85.0	12.4	2.7	82.3	91.0	6.3	2.7	88.3
May-26	78.2	19.0	2.8	75.4	79.7	16.7	3.7	76.0

Table 7: Perceptions and Expectations on Spending- Essential Items								
(Percentage responses)								
Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Increased	Remained Same	Decreased	Net Response	Will Increase	Will Remain Same	Will Decrease	Net Response
May-25	88.3	9.2	2.6	85.7	90.4	7.7	2.0	88.4
May-25	86.7	11.6	1.7	85.0	92.5	4.0	3.5	89.0
Sep-25	88.0	9.4	2.7	85.3	89.1	9.4	1.5	87.7
Nov-25	84.6	12.2	3.2	81.4	88.6	9.1	2.3	86.3
Jan-26	83.8	15.1	1.2	82.6	89.3	8.5	2.2	87.2
Mar-26	85.5	11.6	2.8	82.7	90.2	7.1	2.7	87.5
May-26	83.3	14.0	2.7	80.6	83.6	12.9	3.5	80.1

Table 8: Perceptions and Expectations on Spending- Non-Essential Items								
(Percentage responses)								
Survey Round	Current Perception				One year ahead Expectation			
	Increased	Remained Same	Decreased	Net Response	Will Increase	Will Remain Same	Will Decrease	Net Response
May-25	58.3	18.6	23.1	35.2	69.3	18.4	12.3	56.9
Jul-25	54.7	27.9	17.4	37.2	73.6	10.1	16.4	57.2
Sep-25	53.0	31.4	15.7	37.3	68.3	21.0	10.8	57.5
Nov-25	53.8	27.8	18.4	35.5	69.6	18.6	11.7	57.9
Jan-26	51.1	33.5	15.4	35.6	69.9	19.6	10.6	59.3
Mar-26	52.1	30.4	17.6	34.5	71.2	17.2	11.7	59.5
May-26	51.1	28.0	21.0	30.1	58.1	26.4	15.5	42.6

Table 9: Rural Consumer Confidence Indices		
Survey Round	Current Situation Index (CSI)	Future Expectations Index (FEI)
May-25	100.0	126.2
Jul-25	100.6	127.7
Sep-25	100.9	127.9
Nov-25	100.8	128.6
Jan-26	100.5	129.3
Mar-26	98.0	125.1
May-26	95.2	119.3

Table 10: Current Period Median Inflation Perception of the Various Groups								
	Nov-25		Jan-26		Mar-26		May-26	
	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
Overall	4.6	0.12	5.1	0.09	5.6	0.09	5.9	0.10
Gender-wise								
Male	4.4	0.15	5.1	0.10	5.6	0.12	6.1	0.17
Female	4.8	0.15	5.0	0.14	5.5	0.12	5.8	0.15
Category-wise								
Salaried Employees	4.5	0.26	5.2	0.16	5.6	0.15	5.9	0.23
Self Employed	4.6	0.21	5.0	0.17	5.8	0.20	5.9	0.21
Homemakers	4.8	0.17	4.9	0.15	5.5	0.13	5.9	0.19
Retired Persons	4.9	0.37	6.3	0.52	5.6	0.59	7.0	0.48
Daily Workers	4.5	0.26	5.2	0.15	5.4	0.16	5.9	0.17
Others	4.6	0.24	5.3	0.18	5.3	0.29	6.3	0.47
Age Group-wise								
21 to 29 years	4.7	0.19	5.0	0.17	5.3	0.16	5.9	0.17
30 to 39 years	4.7	0.16	5.0	0.14	5.7	0.16	6.1	0.25
40 to 59 years	4.5	0.19	5.0	0.14	5.6	0.12	6.1	0.21
60 years and above	4.5	0.31	5.3	0.22	5.7	0.24	5.9	0.30

Table 11: One Year Ahead Median Inflation Expectations of Various Groups								
	Nov-25		Jan-26		Mar-26		May-26	
	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
Overall	6.1	0.22	6.2	0.22	6.8	0.23	7.2	0.19
Gender-wise								
Male	6.0	0.26	6.5	0.25	6.8	0.28	7.5	0.24
Female	6.2	0.27	6.1	0.29	6.6	0.30	6.6	0.33
Category-wise								
Salaried Employees	6.3	0.42	6.6	0.37	6.7	0.40	7.2	0.29
Self Employed	5.9	0.34	6.0	0.29	7.0	0.47	7.2	0.32
Homemakers	6.1	0.27	6.0	0.32	6.9	0.33	6.5	0.34
Retired Persons	7.1	1.09	7.7	1.09	6.4	0.81	8.6	0.82
Daily Workers	6.0	0.39	6.6	0.40	6.7	0.35	7.0	0.33
Others	6.7	0.40	7.4	0.57	7.0	0.53	7.9	0.48
Age Group-wise								
21 to 29 years	6.3	0.32	6.8	0.40	6.5	0.30	7.2	0.33
30 to 39 years	6.1	0.30	6.1	0.28	7.3	0.38	7.3	0.34
40 to 59 years	6.3	0.31	6.0	0.23	6.8	0.30	7.3	0.25
60 years and above	5.6	0.32	6.7	0.51	6.7	0.55	7.3	0.34

Table 12: Household Inflation Expectations – Current Perception and One Year Ahead Expectations				
Survey Round	Current Perception		One Year ahead Expectation	
	Median		Median	
	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
May-25	6.3	0.17	8.9	0.19
Jul-25	5.8	0.08	7.9	0.25
Sep-25	5.9	0.13	7.6	0.23
Nov-25	4.6	0.12	6.1	0.22
Jan-26	5.1	0.09	6.2	0.22
Mar-26	5.6	0.09	6.8	0.23
May-26	5.9	0.10	7.2	0.19
Notes: The table provides estimates and standard errors (SE) for quantitative responses.				

Table 13: Cross-tabulation of Number of Respondents by Current Inflation Perception and One Year Ahead Inflation Expectations: May-26																				
		One Year Ahead Inflation Rate (per cent)																		
Current Inflation Rate (per cent)		<1	1-<2	2-<3	3-<4	4-<5	5-<6	6-<7	7-<8	8-<9	9-<10	10-<11	11-<12	12-<13	13-<14	14-<15	15-<16	>=16	No idea	Total
	<1	465	67	70	42	32	31	17	24	27	44	-	22	-	-	-	-	-	-	841
	1-<2	63	45	74	33	25	5	1	-	-	1	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	248
	2-<3	112	56	115	142	193	73	13	16	-	3	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	724
	3-<4	103	16	33	88	161	167	51	23	9	11	-	1	2	-	-	-	-	-	665
	4-<5	136	19	32	43	156	202	160	84	49	43	-	4	1	1	-	-	-	3	933
	5-<6	218	11	18	30	65	219	240	198	127	65	114	13	4	-	2	8	8	2	1342
	6-<7	61	2	5	6	7	21	121	129	73	51	46	11	14	3	2	3	2	6	563
	7-<8	59	-	5	2	8	8	10	112	100	88	150	14	15	5	11	8	1	7	603
	8-<9	34	-	4	1	4	7	1	3	66	71	149	25	34	11	10	8	3	-	431
	9-<10	75	5	4	5	15	12	1	7	17	178	168	55	39	10	63	36	44	1	735
	10-<11	89	1	2	5	6	16	3	-	1	-	104	75	75	15	24	144	137	9	706
	11-<12	5	1	-	1	-	2	-	-	-	1	-	8	6	2	3	3	3	1	37
	12-<13	5	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	11	2	4	6	5	-	36
	13-<14	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	4	-	2	3	-	10
	14-<15	7	1	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	9	27	11	8	65
	15-<16	14	-	-	-	1	2	-	-	-	-	3	-	-	-	1	45	54	-	120
	>=16	113	-	1	1	1	4	2	-	-	-	14	-	-	-	-	3	613	2	754
	Total	1559	224	363	399	677	769	620	599	469	556	749	229	202	53	129	293	884	39	8813